



Governance (GOV)

GOV Overview

Required PA Information

Intent

Provides guidance to senior management on their role in the sponsorship and governance of performance, processes, and related activities.

Value

Minimizes the cost of process implementation, increases the likelihood of meeting objectives, and verifies that the implemented processes support and contribute to the success of the business.

Additional Required PA Information

Senior management must actively participate in identifying business and performance needs and objectives that address all domains and contexts representing the full extent of the organization, e.g., agile, DevSecOps, data management, security, development, services. They must provide necessary budget and resources to develop, implement, and follow process, and to continually improve performance of the projects and organization.

Explanatory PA Information

Practice Summary

Level 1

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| GOV 1.1 | Senior management identifies what is important for doing the work and defines the approach needed to accomplish the objectives of the organization. |
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Level 2

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| GOV 2.1 | Senior management defines, keeps updated, and communicates organizational directives for process implementation and performance improvement based on organization needs and objectives. |
| GOV 2.2 | Senior management provides funding, resources, and training for developing, supporting, performing, improving, and evaluating adherence to processes. |
| GOV 2.3 | Senior management identifies their information needs and uses the collected information to provide governance and oversight of effective process implementation and performance improvement. |
| GOV 2.4 | Senior management assigns authority and holds people accountable for adhering to organization directives and achieving process implementation and performance improvement objectives. |

Level 3

- GOV 3.1 Senior management ensures that measures supporting objectives throughout the organization are collected, analyzed, and used.
- GOV 3.2 Senior management ensures that competencies and processes are aligned with the objectives of the organization.

Level 4

- GOV 4.1 Senior management verifies that selected decisions are driven by statistical and quantitative analysis related to performance and achievement of quality and process performance objectives.

Additional PA Explanatory Information

Senior management involvement is critical to the success of process implementation in an organization.

Senior management:

- Sets the strategy, direction, and expectations for process efforts
- Ensures that processes are aligned with business objectives and needs
- Reinforces and rewards the development and use of processes to ensure their improvement and sustainment
- Monitors the performance and achievements of the processes
- Provides adequate resources for process and performance improvement

Governance process activities are intended to apply to the set of organizational or project processes by identifying process roles for senior management to perform. The purpose of these processes is to improve process sustainment and integration throughout the organization.

Related Practice Areas

Implementation Infrastructure (II)

Context Specific**Data**

Context Tag:	CMMI-DATA
Context:	Use processes to incorporate data management best practices as an integral part of the solution.

Senior Management sponsorship and commitment for managing data must be visible, e.g., in the definition of process needs, organizational objectives and directives, roles and responsibilities, resources, participation, involvement, leadership.

Data objectives cannot be met solely by technologies and techniques alone. High quality is the result of continued scrutiny, shared and communicated across the organization by all stakeholders. An implementable approach for managing data may require a cultural shift, obtained by strong support from executive management and sustained through promoting, educating, and mandating attention to the data assets.

The most effective approach to managing data is visibly and actively endorsed by executive management and supported by mandatory organizational policy.

People

Context Tag:	CMMI-PPL
Context:	Use processes to align workforce performance and business objectives.

Develop competency and work empowerment related objectives that support the overall business objectives. Align workforce competency descriptions with strategic and organizational directives to achieve a balanced approach for continuous performance improvement.

Safety

Context Tag:	CMMI-SAF
Context:	Use processes to incorporate safety considerations as an integral part of the solution, work, project, and organization.

Senior Management sponsorship and commitment for safety must be visible, e.g., in the definition of process needs and objectives, organizational objectives, resources, extraordinary attention, participation, involvement, and leadership. When commitment for any process starts at the top, business objectives and goals flow down through the organization. It is important that Senior Management listens to and acts upon safety issues and concerns raised throughout the organization. Review safety management objectives and policies periodically with affected stakeholders and update as necessary.

Security

Context Tag:	CMMI-SEC
Context:	Use processes to incorporate security considerations as an integral part of the solution, work, project, and organization.

Senior Management sponsorship and commitment for the security strategy and approach must be visible, e.g., in the definition of process needs and objectives, organizational objectives, resources, level of attention, participation, involvement, and leadership. When commitment for any process starts at the top, business objectives and goals flow down through the organization. It is important that Senior Management listens to and acts upon security issues and concerns raised throughout the organization. Review security management objectives and policies periodically with affected stakeholders and update as necessary.

Level 1

GOV 1.1

Required Practice Information

Practice Statement

Senior management identifies what is important for doing the work and defines the approach needed to accomplish the objectives of the organization.

Value

Increases the likelihood that the organization implements and improves processes efficiently and effectively to meet business objectives.

Additional Required Information

Organizational culture and values are reflected in policies, practices, and programs that support success of organizational directives.

Explanatory Practice Information

Additional Explanatory Information

Senior management is responsible for understanding the marketplace, developing business strategies, and defining business objectives. Senior management must set and communicate organizational direction that:

- Governs organizational activities, including process implementation and improvement efforts
- Includes objectives, business strategy, and the approaches intended to address both
- Sets expectations for ensuring that the organization's process efforts support business and performance needs and objectives
- Provides input to improvement plans
- Defines the operational parameters for conducting work, including empowerment mechanisms

Organizational direction is typically provided as statements of policy, strategy, mission, vision, values, and objectives.

Senior managers review, update, and communicate organizational direction periodically or as performance, business needs, and objectives change.

Example Activities

Example Activities	Further Explanation
Senior management decides what is important for accomplishing the work, including improvements; sets the approach; and communicates to the organization.	

Example Work Products

Example Work Products	Further Explanation
Identification of importance of and approach to improvement	
Records of reviews and communications	

Level 2

GOV 2.1

Required Practice Information

Practice Statement

Senior management defines, keeps updated, and communicates organizational directives for process implementation and performance improvement based on organization needs and objectives.

Value

Increases likelihood of meeting organizational needs and objectives because work is performed in accordance with senior management's expectations and priorities.

Additional Required Information

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Explanatory Practice Information

Additional Explanatory Information

Guiding principles, which are essential to a viable business culture, are often recorded in organizational strategies, mission, and vision statements.

A mission statement provides a simple statement of what the organization does, the reason for its existence, and the value it provides to customers, investors, stakeholders, and other interested parties.

A vision statement provides a high-level statement of what the organization wants to achieve strategically in the coming years.

Organizational strategy provides guidance related to:

- Decisions made to achieve long-term objectives
- Actions an organization intends to take to achieve long-term objectives
- Identification of resources needed to accomplish long-term objectives

Guiding principles form the basis for directives. Over time, the directives become ingrained in how the organization implements and improves processes and provide the basis for how the organization does business.

Senior management:

- Defines directives that influence and help focus process implementation and performance improvement efforts on achieving organizational objectives and addressing needs
- Communicates these directives across the organization to ensure that priorities and expectations are understood

- Ensures operational parameters and empowerment mechanisms are established to provide support for successful achievement of directives such as Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) and Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) initiatives and activities

Directives:

- Record what is important to senior management
- Clearly specify which parts of the organization are affected by and held accountable for compliance
- Develop expectations and specify requirements for following organizational standards, implementing, and improving the processes, and sharing information

Review organizational directives on a periodic and as-needed basis to confirm they accurately reflect and support organizational improvement objectives.

The handling of individual concerns is an important component of operational parameters, so that concerns do not escalate to large-scale risks and damages to the organization. A concern is an issue, situation, condition, or grievance that an individual or workgroup wants the organization to address and resolve. Concerns may include, but are not limited to complaints of harassment, bullying, discrimination, or abusive behavior.

Senior management verifies individuals, workgroups, and units of the workforce are informed of related practices, policies, and programs that affect them. For example:

- Hiring policies
- Training and development policies
- Compensation policies
- Career growth policies
- Promotion and transfer procedures
- Retraining practices
- Procedures for raising a concern
- Performance management practices

Example Activities

Example Activities	Further Explanation
Senior management defines and communicates organizational directives based on guiding principles.	Although senior managers are responsible and accountable for defining policies, other members of the organization, such as process improvement team members, often participate in developing directives. Senior management communicates policies, practices, and programs to the workforce on a periodic basis. This includes clarification about updates and changes to the policies, practices, and programs. Senior management confirms awareness of the policies, practices, and programs are periodically evaluated for effectiveness, and takes corrective action when misunderstandings are identified.

Example Activities	Further Explanation
Senior management defines procedures for individuals to raise concerns through multiple channels, confirms those procedures are followed, and confirms that the raised concerns are addressed.	The procedure typically specifies: • How a concern may be raised • Requirements for tracking and resolving concerns that have been raised • Degree of confidentiality to be maintained • How responses should be provided regarding a concern • How to conduct and record a meeting, if needed, to discuss possible resolutions of a concern • Follow up activities after problem-solving meetings • Consequences for attribution or confidentiality breaches
Senior management reviews and refines process implementation and performance improvement objectives to ensure alignment with the guiding principles.	Other members of the organization may provide input on process implementation and performance improvement objectives. These people may include: • Executive managers • Functional managers • Members of a steering committee • Subject Matter Experts (SMEs) To ensure that processes remain aligned with the organizational strategy, senior management must be involved in prioritizing improvement objectives, based on periodic and event driven review.
Senior management communicates organizational and unit performance information and results.	Summarize information about organizational and unit performance at an appropriate level of detail for use by individuals, workgroups, or units. Communicate this information using methods that make the information readily accessible and useful for decision-making or other business activities. Examples of information to communicate include: • Performance objectives aligned to specific units or divisions of the organization • Financial results and projections • Information about costs and expenses • Production data and results • Quality objectives and results • Customer satisfaction and related information • Marketing, sales, and related information Make the workforce aware of the extent to which different forms of performance information must be treated as confidential.
Senior management communicates performance improvement directives.	Communication should take place through different channels and may include: • In-person discussions and meetings • All-hands meeting content and minutes

Example Activities	Further Explanation
	• Videos • Websites and blogs • Corporate newsletters and boards • Annual report • Marketing material • Emails • Orientation package • Training materials • Social media
Senior management leverages best practice frameworks and models as appropriate to define and integrate a performance, risk, and compliance approach.	Governance, management and assurance of performance, risk and compliance integration require common capabilities and methods. This is frequently referred to as a Governance, Risk, and Compliance (GRC) approach.
Senior management reviews and updates performance improvement directives on a periodic or event-driven basis.	This activity may involve input from other members of the organization such as functional managers, a steering committee, and SMEs. After internal or external changes, the organization may need to review the relevance of directives.

Example Work Products

Example Work Products	Further Explanation
Organizational improvement directives	
Material containing workforce related policies, practices, and programs	Must be accessible to all affected stakeholders. For example: • Orientation material for new hires • Organizational websites • Notice boards • Employee handbooks Examples of information to communicate to the workforce: • Mission, vision, and strategic objectives • Business ethics • Values • Business plans and objectives • Financial results and conditions • Business performance • Quality, productivity, cost, or time-to-market results • Structure or processes changes • Leadership team changes • External business conditions and impacts • New products, services, and markets

Example Work Products	Further Explanation
	• Updates to workforce related policies, practices, and programs
Recorded, updated, and integrated performance, risk, and compliance approach	This may be captured within a GRC program.
Assessment reports on the awareness of workforce related policies, practices, and programs	
Records of corrective actions and solutions for improving awareness	
Records of reported concerns	
Records of communication	Multiple vehicles may be used to reinforce the message, as different people are better tuned to different vehicles. Examples of communication mechanisms include: • Orientation material • Posters • Town hall meetings • Intranet or internal web pages • Organization-wide meetings • Staff meetings • One-on-one meetings • Bulletin boards • Email announcements • Internal publications • Newsletters • Memos, emails, and blog posts from leadership

GOV 2.2

Required Practice Information

Practice Statement

Senior management provides funding, resources, and training for developing, supporting, performing, improving, and evaluating adherence to processes.

Value

Increases the likelihood that senior management's priorities for improvement will be met.

Additional Required Information

Resources must be of sufficient quality and quantity, based on resource capacity and availability, to perform these activities. Senior management identifies and provides adequate funding and resources to individuals who own processes and to those who are identified to perform a process role in recorded project or organizational processes.

Explanatory Practice Information

Additional Explanatory Information

Senior management prioritizes resource allocation across the organization. This supports the capabilities necessary to achieve the desired performance results by balancing resource needs against availability. For processes to be performed as defined and expected, senior management must provide adequate resources to develop, perform, improve, support, and evaluate adherence to those processes. Resources may include people, funding, tools, equipment, facilities, environment, and consumables. Resources also include senior management's time and attention.

Senior management should focus on prioritizing resources to meet both short- and long-term objectives and encourage repeatable and consistent process performance.

The adequacy of resources depends on availability, capacity, and capability and can change over time. Sufficient resources must be provided to ensure that needed expertise, facilities, or tools are available. Senior management should consider increasing available resources or removing requirements, constraints, or commitments to address needs. Information that can be used to determine if resources are sufficient includes:

- Roles and responsibilities definition
- Needed and available skills, knowledge, and experience
- Cost
- Description of facilities
- Tool availability and appropriateness
- List of equipment
- Environment description
- List of consumables, including amounts
- Timeframe of availability
- Dependencies

Senior management's most valuable resource is their time. For improvement efforts to be successful, senior management must provide ongoing, visible, and active support.

Example Activities

Example Activities	Further Explanation
Senior management approves and provides the funding and resources needed to develop, perform, improve, and monitor the process.	The scope of the funding and resources aligns to all domains and contexts that represent the full extent of the organization, e.g., agile, data management, security, development, services, suppliers.

Example Activities	Further Explanation
Senior management reviews, revises, and communicates assignment of needed funding, personnel, and resources to develop, perform, improve, and monitor the process.	
Senior management provides directives for training.	Training addresses all aspects of learning, including required content and delivery mechanisms, e.g., in-person, traditional classroom, mentoring, elearning, on-the-job training.
Senior management reviews and refines the allocation of budget and resources.	

Example Work Products

Example Work Products	Further Explanation
Recorded allocation of needed funding, training, and resources approved by senior management	
Records of reviews and communications	

GOV 2.3

Required Practice Information

Practice Statement

Senior management identifies their information needs and uses the collected information to provide governance and oversight of effective process implementation and performance improvement.

Value

Aligns the information senior management receives with their business needs to increase the likelihood of meeting business objectives.

Additional Required Information

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Explanatory Practice Information

Additional Explanatory Information

Senior management must identify the information necessary to:

- Make timely and informed decisions
- Understand status and when to act on it
- Reinforce the importance of performance improvement
- Align organizational process improvement efforts to meet objectives

Process effectiveness indicates the organization's capability to achieve performance objectives. Senior management can determine how efficient and effective processes are by comparing process implementation and improvement results to process improvement and performance objectives.

Senior management identifies and prioritizes the information they need about process capability and performance improvement. Senior management provides guidance and direction to align measures and activities with identified information needs and objectives. Senior management reviews information to understand:

- Current process improvement status and its effectiveness
- Organizational performance
- If business objectives are being met
- Capability of current processes to meet current and future objectives
- When and where to take corrective action

Senior management uses periodic and event-driven reviews to obtain insight into organizational process improvement activities. These reviews are for senior managers who provide the policy and overall guidance for the process and not for those who perform the day-to-day monitoring and controlling of the process.

During the reviews, senior management:

- Reviews measurement results and addresses issues
- Reviews status against process improvement plans and addresses issues
- Reviews results of process implementation and addresses issues
- Reviews progress against tactical and operational objectives

The scope, length, content, level of abstraction, and frequency of these reviews depend on the needs of senior management. Reviews enable senior management to understand and take action on the planning, deployment, implementation, use, performance, and improvement of processes.

Information reported to senior managers improves their insight into the process to ensure the organization manages work, achieves objectives, and improves performance. Measures provide objective information that is used to make informed decisions and take appropriate corrective action. The information reported to senior management may be provided in summary form.

Example Activities

Example Activities	Further Explanation
Senior management identifies and keeps up to date their information needs related to process capability, improvement, and performance objectives.	This includes approval of how the needed information is obtained, analyzed, and reported in alignment with established criteria for managing data.
Senior management verifies that measures supporting the organization's objectives are defined.	Measures: • Align to organizational objectives • Support the organization's ability to manage its performance results
Senior management reviews activities, accomplishments, status, and results of the process implementation and improvement activities.	Reviews of the process, performance, work products, and solutions include: • Reviewing against the plan for implementing and improving process capability and resulting performance • Reviewing with the immediate level of management responsible for process implementation and improvement activities • Reviewing measurement data and qualitative information • Identifying issues by: ○ Reviewing performance ○ Collecting and using measures ○ Deploying, implementing, using, performing, and improving the process • Determining if corrective action is needed
Senior management oversees updates to the process implementation and improvement plans.	
Senior management oversees the appropriate integration of measurement and analysis activities into all organization processes.	Use of measurements supports: • Objective planning and estimating • Tracking actual progress and performance against plans and objectives • Identifying and resolving process-related issues • Providing a basis for incorporating measurement into additional processes in the future

Example Work Products

Example Work Products	Further Explanation
Senior management information needs	The people collecting and reporting the information must understand its importance and use. Senior management may not share sensitive or private information with the organization.
Standard reporting format or agenda for review with senior management	Includes discussion items and expected content identified by senior management for the review. Report templates and tools provide an understandable, easily interpreted format for communicating the information identified for review by senior management. Reports may be produced periodically or as needed. Reports focus on the information needs identified by senior management using defined reporting formats and may include: • Measures • Data • Analysis of data, e.g., trend analysis, objective achievement analysis
List of measures	Includes base and derived measures related to senior management improvement information needs and objectives.
Review results	May include: • Topics reviewed • Measures reported • Decisions made • Proposed process changes • Proposed policy revisions • Results from objective evaluations • Action items with assignments and due dates May be provided as: • Meeting minutes provided to all participants • Direction from senior management • Other communication from senior management

Related Practice Areas

Managing Performance and Measurement (MPM)

GOV 2.4

Required Practice Information

Practice Statement

Senior management assigns authority and holds people accountable for adhering to organization directives and achieving process implementation and performance improvement objectives.

Value

Ensures that directives drive the implementation and improvement of processes to meet business objectives.

Additional Required Information

Senior Management identifies, analyzes, and records authority and the alignment to roles, responsibilities, and decision-making. This includes identification of individuals who own processes and individuals who perform process roles in recorded project or organizational processes.

Explanatory Practice Information

Additional Explanatory Information

Senior management holds people accountable by:

- Verifying and enforcing compliance with organizational directives
- Reviewing commitments that have an organizational impact and ensuring they are met

Periodically and on an event-driven basis, senior management reviews and addresses issues related to:

- Adherence to organizational directives, practices, and procedures
- Process and performance improvement
- Adherence to relevant laws and regulations
- Resolution of noncompliance issues
- Organization performance and improvement trends
- Workforce competency improvements
- Fulfilling commitments that have an organizational impact

Example Activities

Example Activities	Further Explanation
Senior management reviews issues and trends related to deploying, implementing, performing, and improving the organization's processes.	This may include: • Verifying information is accurate and complete • Ensuring that the results of reviews are communicated • Ensuring directives are consistently followed

Example Activities	Further Explanation
Senior management directs corrective actions when: • The organization's objectives are not being met • Issues are identified • Implementation and improvement progress differs from the plans	Corrective action includes assigning resources, responsibilities, and planned completion dates. This may include: • Taking remedial action to repair defective solutions • Changing the plan • Adjusting resources, e.g., people and tools • Negotiating changes to commitments • Reviewing the objectives and making changes • Terminating the effort
Senior management directs the recording and updating of roles, responsibilities, and authority.	Maintain the roles, responsibilities, and authority information to keep it consistent and current. Ensure changes are recorded and communicated.
Senior management provides incentives for improvement.	This may include recognizing or rewarding: • Individuals or teams that meet or exceed improvement objectives • When objectives are met without difficulties rather than only rewarding when big problems are resolved • When implementation progress differs from the plan in a positive way, e.g., early delivery, under budget, and exceeds quality objectives This may also include taking remedial or disciplinary actions when: • Individuals or teams are not meeting improvement objectives • Implementation progress differs from the plan in a negative way, e.g., late delivery, over budget, and poor quality

Example Work Products

Example Work Products	Further Explanation
Action items related to accountability	This may include: • Definition of issue • Assignment of responsibility • Due date • Status
Rewards, recognitions, and incentives	This may include: • Promotions • Bonuses or salary increases • Certificates • Employee of the Month • Public recognition

Example Work Products	Further Explanation
List of consequences and potential impacts	This may include: • Counseling • Remediation • Training • Reassignment • Demotion or dismissal
Organizational roles and responsibilities document	

Related Practice Areas

Process Quality Assurance (PQA)

Level 3

GOV 3.1

Required Practice Information

Practice Statement

Senior management ensures that measures supporting objectives throughout the organization are collected, analyzed, and used.

Value

Increases the organization's ability to successfully deliver its solutions.

Additional Required Information

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Explanatory Practice Information

Additional Explanatory Information

Senior management verifies:

- Appropriate measures are implemented, collected, analyzed, used, and communicated
- Measures support decisions related to the organization's and projects' performance and capability
- Organizational direction and process improvement strategies are updated based on measures of performance

Example Activities

Example Activities	Further Explanation
Senior management verifies measures are collected, analyzed, and used.	
Senior management directs corrective actions related to collecting, analyzing, and using measures.	May include: • Adjusting resources • Modifying the plans • Updating organizational objectives

Example Work Products

Example Work Products	Further Explanation
Updated organizational measurement repository	

Example Work Products	Further Explanation
Status reports, actions, and decisions	These may: • Result from the collection, analysis, and use of measures. • Be used for performing work relating to performance and process improvement, solution delivery, etc.
Updated organizational directives and objectives	Based on process performance results, consider updates to the following items: • Organizational strategy • Mission statement • Vision statement • Policies

GOV 3.2

Required Practice Information

Practice Statement

Senior management ensures that competencies and processes are aligned with the objectives of the organization.

Value

Improves the capability of the organization to meet its objectives.

Additional Required Information

Senior management provides funding and resources to:

- Define performance objectives
- Define and follow processes needed to meet performance objectives
- Identify and assign personnel with the knowledge and skills necessary to perform the processes

Explanatory Practice Information

Additional Explanatory Information

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Example Activities

Example Activities	Further Explanation
Review the status of competencies, objectives, and processes.	Focuses on aligning: • Strategies • Objectives • Process reviews

Example Activities	Further Explanation
	• Competencies
Record and communicate results.	

Example Work Products

Example Work Products	Further Explanation
Results of strategy and process reviews and discussions	May include: • Meeting minutes • Records of decisions and direction • Action items • Updated objectives
Reviews and comparisons between the organization's competencies and processes to be executed	May include analyzing: • Personnel profiles • Skills matrices • Job descriptions

Related Practice Areas

Workforce Empowerment (WE)

Level 4

GOV 4.1

Required Practice Information

Practice Statement

Senior management verifies that selected decisions are driven by statistical and quantitative analysis related to performance and achievement of quality and process performance objectives.

Value

Strengthens decision-making by using statistical and quantitative analysis to optimize organizational performance.

Additional Required Information

Senior management identifies and provides funding and resources to establish a capability for analyzing and using quantitative and statistical techniques and data to manage and improve organizational performance.

Explanatory Practice Information

Additional Explanatory Information

As an organization becomes more capable, it develops a statistical and quantitative understanding of the effectiveness of its standard processes. This provides senior management with visibility into how effectively the processes support achieving business objectives and gives insight into performance variation which enables:

- Quantifying, understanding, and managing risk
- Ensuring that timely and effective actions are taken to address issues

Example Activities

Example Activities	Further Explanation
Review and discuss strategy, process performance, decisions, and progress.	Strategy includes senior management setting expectations for continuous data-driven improvement and optimization. Include related statistical and quantitative analyses and ensure decisions are based on the analyses.
Record and communicate results.	Identify and review results of performance improvement efforts to promote performance improvement across the organization.

Example Work Products

Example Work Products	Further Explanation
Results of strategy, process performance, and progress reviews and decision analyses	Reference the statistical and quantitative analyses that drive the decisions and related actions.
Communicated results	Results can be communicated through email, corporate newsletters, town halls, team meetings, etc.

Related Practice Areas

Managing Performance and Measurement (MPM)

